

CUSTOMER SERVICE STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP)

How to Handle Customer General Inquiry SOP

Company Name: Center for Customer Service Excellence

Street Address: Sothearos Street

City, State, and Zip: Phnom Penh, Cambodia 120203

webaddress.com: <https://csxzelent.com>

Version 1.1.0

Date: 08/01/26 (MM/DD/YY)

Department Responsible: Customer Service Operations

Version History			
Version No.	1.1.0	Current Version Date	01 August 2026
Effective Date	15 August 2026	Expiration Date	11 November 2026
Responsible Person	Jake Marley (Head of Operations)	Signature	
Writer	Dean Boone (Advisory Team / Lead Agent)	Approval	Zack Kuchzner (Quality Assurance Manager)

INTRODUCTION

Describe the purpose of your customer service department - who your customers are and what their needs are.

The primary purpose of the Customer Service Department is to perform all support functions in a repeatable and reliable way, transitioning from haphazard methods to a standardized "One Best Way" for every interaction. By codifying these procedures, we ensure consistency across all service channels and provide the stable baseline necessary for continuous improvement. This SOP is designed to optimize three critical areas of performance: efficiency by streamlining workflows and reducing waste; quality by delivering accurate results that meet customer requirements every time; and safety by minimizing financial and reputational risks to the organization and its clients.

Our customers primarily consist of [External Clients/Policyholders] who rely on our expertise for [Account Management/Technical Support/Conflict Resolution]. Their needs center on receiving swift and accurate resolutions through interactions that are simple, clear, and personal. We recognize that customers do not view interactions as single touchpoints but as end-to-end journeys; therefore, our mission is to make these journeys effortless and empathetic, providing peace of mind and strengthening the emotional connection between the customer and the company.

By following this standardized procedure, staff members contribute to an ownership culture where excellence is not an accident but a predictable and repeatable result.

EXAMPLES

Provide sample case scenarios to illustrate how the SOP works.

The following sample case scenarios illustrate how the "One Best Way" is applied to different customer interactions. These examples demonstrate the transition from haphazard responses to a standardized, reliable workflow that values the customer's time.

Scenario A: Routine Status Inquiry (Normal Priority)

- **Situation:** A customer calls to ask for the expected disbursement date of their processed claim.
- **Channel:** Phone.
- **Action Taken:**
 1. **Verification:** The agent uses the **simplified verification protocol** (Full name and last 4 digits of ID) to keep the journey effortless.
 2. **Logging:** The agent opens a CRM record immediately to make the inquiry "visible".
 3. **Triage:** Categorized as "**General Information**" and assigned "**Normal**" priority.
 4. **Resolution:** The agent consults the digital "One Best Way Guide" for status checks and provides the customer with a **specific date** for when the funds will be released.
- **Outcome:** The inquiry is resolved "first-time right" at the point of contact, preventing a follow-up call.

Scenario B: Billing Error (High Priority)

- **Situation:** A customer sends an email stating they were charged twice for their monthly premium.
- **Channel:** Email.
- **Action Taken:**
 1. **Logging & Acknowledgment:** The automated system generates a **Case Number** and sends an acknowledgment within 1 hour.
 2. **Triage:** The agent categorizes this as "**Billing Error**" and assigns "**High**" priority.
 3. **Resolution:** The agent follows the billing reconciliation SOP, identifies the duplicate transaction, and initiates a refund.
 4. **Validation:** The agent sends a personal email confirmation to the customer with the refund transaction number.
- **Outcome:** The issue is resolved within the **same business day**, meeting the High priority SLA.

Scenario C: Unauthorized Account Access (Critical Priority & Escalation)

- **Situation:** A customer reports through Live Chat that they cannot log in and suspect their account has been compromised.
- **Channel:** Live Chat.
- **Action Taken:**
 1. **Identification:** The agent recognizes this as a high-risk security/fraud concern.
 2. **Triage:** Assigned "**Critical**" priority.
 3. **Immediate Escalation:** Following the **Escalation Procedure**, the agent immediately alerts the **Area Team Leader** and the **Fraud Specialist**.
 4. **Ownership:** The Fraud Specialist assumes ownership of the journey, secures the account, and acknowledges the issue with the customer **within 30 minutes**.
 5. **Root-Cause Review:** The incident is recorded as a "**gold nugget**" to be discussed at the next **Morning Huddle** to determine if a Poka-Yoke (mistake-proofing) control is needed in the login process.
- **Outcome:** The risk is mitigated rapidly through tiered accountability, providing the customer with peace of mind.

DISCLAIMER

Any articles, templates, or information provided by Smartsheet on the website are for reference only. While we strive to keep the information up to date and correct, we make no representations or warranties of any kind, express or implied, about the completeness, accuracy, reliability, suitability, or availability with respect to the website or the information, articles, templates, or related graphics contained on the website. Any reliance you place on such information is therefore strictly at your own risk.